VIT Bhopal University

VITyarthi – Course Project

Digital Literacy (CSE 0001) - NGMC

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-: Introduction :-

This is the brief Introduction of the given project assignment:

As a newly selected student Digital Ambassador, My role is to help my peers navigate the digital world effectively and responsibly. To achieve this, I have developed a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio to present to the faculty committee and share with my batch.

This project consists of five tasks that map directly to the core modules of the CSE0001 course. Through these tasks, I have created visual awareness infographics, built a foundational digital portfolio on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, and explored essential collaboration tools. Furthermore, the project addresses critical communication skills by drafting professional emails and tackles online safety through a cybercrime case study and prevention checklist. Ultimately, this portfolio serves as a practical guide to mastering the digital tools and etiquette required for academic and professional success.

-: Task-1: Write-up or Description :-

- **Tool Used & What I Made** :- For Task-1 requirements, I utilized **Canva** to design a Digital Literacy Awareness infographic. I selected this tool for its smooth and User-friendly Graphic interface and it also provides a large number of designing elements and editing tools, fulfill all the requirements to make the given work innovative and productive also it's a free design tool.

- **What The Design Shows** :- My infographic covers three of the required topic on digital literacy to guide my peers.
  - First, It Makes you understand with "What is Digital Literacy?" as an ability to efficiently use and find the right way of digital tools and applications.
  - Second, It highlights some of the useful digital tools for students, featuring platforms for Group assignments (i.e. Google Workspace), for Coders to Organizes their work Platforms like GitHub and for designing platforms like Canva etc.
  - Finally, It focuses on the Digital safety or safe internet practices specifically emphasize over strong passcodes and verifying sources to prevent threats.

- **Reflection on the process** :- The Most Interesting aspect of this task was learning a new skill to make interactive infographics, presentations also while working with Canva how it crates my words to visual form and combines this visuals with my innovations can create an incredible infographic for my Batchmates… And The Most Difficult aspect as a first-time User working on Canva was Using its editing tool kits for sometimes as there are a number of tools but after some time when I was familiar with the things the overall process moves very Smooth and Effective.

-: Task-2: Write-up or Description :-

- **Platforms chosen** :- For Task-2 requirements, I chose to set up my foundational digital portfolio across three distinct platforms: **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**.

- **What Each Platform is used for** :- The use-case of each platforms are :
  - First, GitHub: It is a developer-focused and primarily used as a web-based platform mainly for version control, code hosting, managing, and collaborating on software development projects using the Git version control system and also provides as a storage for code, track changes, and efficient working from anywhere in the world.
  - Second, LinkedIn: This is a world's largest professional networking site, primarily used for job hunting, building professional industry connections, and maintaining an online digital resume for personal branding allows to showcase their skills, connect with industry peers, and share content to establish professional authority.
  - Third, Kaggle: This is a popular Google platform and a specialized community platform designed for data science and machine learning, often used to compete in predictive modeling challenges, explore and clean datasets, host ML code and collaborate with digital community of data professionals, basically acts as a training ground or a portfolio builder.

- **My plans for the next four years** :- on LinkedIn, plan to actively document my academic milestone during my B.Tech journey and future opportunities. On GitHub, plan to use as a central workspace for my coursework and build a public portfolio of my

coding progress and finally on Kaggle, plan to practice with real-world datasets, and participates in the coding challenges which helps in sharpen my skills in the field.

-: Task-3: Write-up or Description :-

- **Platform(s) chosen** :- For Task-3 requirements, I chosen HackerRank and Google Workspace (specifically Google Forms and Google Sheets) for exploring both coding and collaboration tools.
- **What I build & practiced** :- As part-A stated for coding challenges, on HackerRank, I mainly focused on building my foundational programming skills by completing multiple beginner-level challenges like: "say, Hello, World!", "Python If-Else", and "Arithmetic operations". Results in earning 35 points towards my first python badge. And for part-B collaboration requirement, I designed a small five question interactive quiz on the topic "Digital Literacy Awareness" using Google Forms to test my batchmates knowledge on Digital Literacy and also link this form directly to Google Sheet for automatically capturing and organizing multiple responses at same time.
- **How these tools help in my academics** :- These platforms are highly relevant for my entire academic process. HackerRank provides as an excellent hand-on practice ground works as a constant logic-builder and refinery tool for my coding skills and also helps in exposing multiple real-life problems. Simultaneously, on the other hand mastering Google Forms and Sheets provides me with a great collaborative skills, which will be very helpful in coordinating group assignments or even used as surveying tool for collecting real life data for further research purposes.

-: Task-4: Write-up or Description :-

- **Platform chosen for document creation** :- For Task-4 requirements, I have chosen the basic text editor (Notepad) for completing part-A, i.e: drafting two professional emails (one for extending assignment deadline and another for summer internships inquiry) and part-B, i.e: simple checklist of 5 do's and don'ts for social media use.

- **Impact of poor communication** :- Poor communication can sometimes leave a much more dangerous impact than imagined. Let's talk about a particular incident…a student named Arjun, who was constantly looking for some recommendation for his internship opportunity and for this he has sent an email to his professor in a very informal and casual tone full of fancy words and in response of his mail he received a delayed reply from the professor which lacks support and warmth from his side.
- **Key Takeaway that leads the situation better** :- The above situation is enough to talk about how an incorrect structure and tone leads you to disaster. Instead of sending a professional mail if he sends a professional mail results are very much different and oriented toward him with a proper support and guidance of his professor and furthermore he also not reminds about that these are his permanent digital footprints and can leads his career in a good way or in a future ignorance.

-: Task-5: Write-up or Description :-

- **Topic Explored** :- For Task-5 requirements, For part-A, I researched on the topic of UPI/Online payment frauds and developed a strong case study about how scammers use fake offers to manipulate students in their traps and scammed them. For part-B, I drafted a prevention checklist with 8 specific points you must use in your daily habits while using any online platform and also mention support regarding cybercrimes.
- **Surprising Discovery** :- The most surprising discovery during my research was how these scammers create a scenario, where your knowledge doesn't come in your practice and this creates a main reason of these type of incidents to happen.
- **Habit Change** :- Moving ahead, a major habit that I will change after this research is: I must implement a strict personal rule to never rush while entering any sensitive detail in any critical or speedy situation and will always verify the source before clicking some link or going through a payment gateway also try to ignore these type of offers and calls from unknown sources.

-: Conclusion- Overall learning from the project :-

Creating this digital literacy project has been an incredible experience for me as a first-year engineering student. Throughout these five tasks, I have learned about how to use platform like: Canva, for creating interactive slides and infographics , also created my profiles in LinkedIn, GitHub and Kaggle, which helps in building my digital portfolio and also understand the use-case of some interactive platforms like HackerRank and Google Workspaces. In addition to learning of tools, understands some crucial topics like: professional-emails construct, learning how to protect myself against cyber frauds like UPI frauds and all.

This project also helps me a in achieving a good foundation of digital literacy and now I am much confident in using these digital tech platforms and AI tools also with a great knowledge of communication importance and cyber awareness in this modern world.